

blood circulation

Propelled by the contractions of the heart, blood travels through the blood vessels of the body bringing oxygen and nutrients and removing waste.

principal arteries

The arteries (except for the pulmonary arteries) distribute oxygenated blood throughout the body.

common carotid artery

Branch of the aorta flowing to the head and upper portion of the neck; it is divided into internal and external carotid arteries.

arch of aorta

Second segment of the aorta, which branches into the arteries flowing to the head and upper limbs; with the ascending aorta, it forms the arch of the aorta.

subclavian artery

Main artery of the upper limb passing through the clavicle and extending through the axillary artery; it also flows to the lower section of the neck.

axillary artery

Artery crossing the hollow of the armpit and extending through the brachial artery; it also circulates through the thoracic wall and the shoulder.

brachial artery

Artery flowing along the humerus and supplying the flexor muscles of the arm; it divides into the radial and ulnar arteries at the bend in the elbow.

common iliac artery

Branch of the abdominal aorta that circulates blood to the pelvis and the lower limbs; it divides into the internal and external iliac arteries.

internal iliac artery

Branch of the common iliac artery flowing to the pelvis, the genital organs and the inner thigh.

femoral artery

Main artery of the lower limb; it is a continuation of the external iliac artery and runs along the femur.

anterior tibial artery

Artery running along the front of the leg and supplying blood to the extensor muscles; it extends through the dorsal artery of the foot.

pulmonary artery

Artery carrying blood that is poor in oxygen and rich in carbon dioxide to the lungs; it is the only artery that transports oxygen-poor blood.

renal artery

Branch of the abdominal aorta circulating blood to the kidney.

superior mesenteric artery

Branch of the abdominal aorta that supplies blood to the ascending colon and half of the transverse colon.

abdominal aorta

Fourth segment of the aorta circulating to all the organs and to the walls of the abdomen; it branches into the common iliac arteries.

dorsalis pedis artery

Artery flowing to the ankle and the back of the foot.

arch of foot artery

Continuation of the dorsalis pedis artery; it divides into the arteries of the metatarsus.

